SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

10 August 2021 · Shift 1

67 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 33 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

English Language 25 questions

Q.1

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A large cage, building or enclosure to keep birds

(A) Zoo
(B) Apiary
(C) Aquarium
(D) Aviary

Q.2

Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word. Expunge

(A) Insert
(B) Deplete
(C) Exhaust
(D) Remove

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Uphold

(A) Support
(B) Maintain
(C) Endorse
(D) Oppose

Q.4

Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Select the option that gives their correct order. A. His school was closed as it was the height of summer. B. It was on one such day that Ranji discovered a pool in the forest. C. As he had no friends yet, he wandered alone in the hills and forests. D. Ranji had been less than a month in Rajpur.

(A) ACBD
(B) CBDA
(C) BADC
(D) DACB

Q.5

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. The Prime Minister chair a high-level meeting / with senior officials / to review the Covid situation.

(A) with senior officials
(B) The Prime Minister chair a high-level meeting
(C) to review the Covid situation
(D) No error

Q.6

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. In the past month, the price of oil has _____ several times.

(A) fumbled
(B) fluctuated
(C) faltered
(D) failed

Q.7

Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words. Leather straps put around a horse's head to control it

(A) bridle
(B) bridal
(C) saddle
(D) stirrup

Q.8

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. Mother said, "All the guests will arrive tonight."

(A) Mother said that all the guests would arrive that night.
(B) Mother said that all the guests will arrive tonight.
(C) Mother told that all the guests would arrive tonight.
(D) Mother said that all the guests will arrive that night.

Q.9

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. The word Jama means 'a robe or shawl' and War means 'Yard (the measuring unit)'. B. Jamawar (also spelled as Jamavar) is a fabric that has its roots in Kashmir. C. People in the earlier times used to buy a yard of the shawl to protect themselves from the chilly winter. D. The Jamawar is an adulterated form of Pashmina silk since it contains a blend of cotton and wool.

(A) BACD
(B) BCAD
(C) DCBA
(D) DCAB

Q.10

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Rank and file

(A) The manager of a personnel department
(B) Ordinary workers in a company
(C) Financial activities in a firm
(D) A very well-organised company

Q.11

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. My brother has decided to settle in London "for good".

(A) forever
(B) briefly
(C) for a better income
(D) for a promotion

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. "Unless someone makes a complaint," they will not clear the garbage from the street.

(A) Without someone makes a complaint
(B) No substitution required
(C) Despite someone makes a complaint
(D) Except someone makes a complaint

Q.13

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Plump
(B) Muscle
(C) Gnaw
(D) Rinckle

Q.14

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. We are yet living in the same house.

(A) We are
(B) same house
(C) in the
(D) yet living

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. FORSAKE

(A) desert
(B) hold
(C) claim
(D) help

Q.16

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Profuse

(A) Meagre
(B) Abundant
(C) Limited
(D) Consistent

Q.17

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. The clouds hid the sun.

(A) The sun was hidden by the clouds.
(B) The sun is hidden by the clouds.
(C) The clouds are hid by the sun.
(D) The sun was hide by the clouds.

Q.18

Select the misspelt word.

(A) mature
(B) mischief
(C) misrable
(D) moisture

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'. How long have you "being seating" on this bench?

(A) being sat
(B) No substitution
(C) been sitting
(D) been seating

Q.20

Fill in the blank with most appropriate word. The air _____ has gone up significantly.

(A) rent
(B) charge
(C) cost
(D) fare

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Kashmiri carpets have been appreciated since a long time for their intricate work. Their uniqueness (1) _____ in their manufacturing. These carpets are (2) _____ handmade and are knotted, not tufted. You can (3) _____ different carpets from a variety of silk or woolen ones. These are (4) _____ in colourful themes. The main art of carpet manufacturing is (5) _____ with the knotting. These knots determine the durability and value of the carpet.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(A) is lying
(B) lying
(C) lies
(D) lie

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Kashmiri carpets have been appreciated since a long time for their intricate work. Their uniqueness (1) _____ in their manufacturing. These carpets are (2) _____ handmade and are knotted, not tufted. You can (3) _____ different carpets from a variety of silk or woolen ones. These are (4) _____ in colourful themes. The main art of carpet manufacturing is (5) _____ with the knotting. These knots determine the durability and value of the carpet.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(A) absolutely
(B) merely
(C) simply
(D) purely

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Kashmiri carpets have been appreciated since a long time for their intricate work. Their uniqueness (1) _____ in their manufacturing. These carpets are (2) _____ handmade and are knotted, not tufted. You can (3) _____ different carpets from a variety of silk or woolen ones. These are (4) _____ in colourful themes. The main art of carpet manufacturing is (5) _____ with the knotting. These knots determine the durability and value of the carpet.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(A) indicate
(B) elect
(C) choose
(D) decide

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Kashmiri carpets have been appreciated since a long time for their intricate work. Their uniqueness (1) _____ in their manufacturing. These carpets are (2) _____ handmade and are knotted, not tufted. You can (3) _____ different carpets from a variety of silk or woolen ones. These are (4) _____ in colourful themes. The main art of carpet manufacturing is (5) _____ with the knotting. These knots determine the durability and value of the carpet.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(A) devised
(B) designed
(C) defined
(D) described

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Kashmiri carpets have been appreciated since a long time for their intricate work. Their uniqueness (1) _____ in their manufacturing. These carpets are (2) _____ handmade and are knotted, not tufted. You can (3) _____ different carpets from a variety of silk or woolen ones. These are (4) _____ in colourful themes. The main art of carpet manufacturing is (5) _____ with the knotting. These knots determine the durability and value of the carpet.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(A) assisted
(B) abetted
(C) attended
(D) associated

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Q.2

Four options have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the option that is different.

(A) Delhi
(B) Puducherry
(C) Chandigarh
(D) Jammu & Kashmir

Q.5

Four number-pairs have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the one that is different.

(A) 17 : 291
(B) 15 : 227
(C) 13 : 169
(D) 11 : 123

Q.6

Select the option in which the numbers share the same relationship as that shared by the numbers in the given set. (7, 4, 33)

(A) (9, 5, 56)
(B) (7, 4, 71)
(C) (8, 5, 40)
(D) (11, 8, 175)

Q.7

Which two digits need to be interchanged so as to balance the given equation? $75 \div 18 + 51 \times 8 - 82 = 87$

(A) 7 and 8
(B) 1 and 5
(C) 5 and 2
(D) 8 and 2

Q.10

If Raman is the brother of the son of Kshitij's son, how is Raman related to Kshitij?

(A) Grandson
(B) Nephew
(C) Cousin
(D) Son

Q.12

Select the word-pair in which the two words are related in the same way as are the two words in the following word-pair. Growth : Expansion

(A) Child : Birth
(B) Urge : Request
(C) First : Last
(D) Temporary : Permanent

Q.13

Three of the following four letter-clusters are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the odd one.

(A) KMQT
(B) LNQU
(C) QSVZ
(D) ACFJ

Q.14

Select the correct option that indicates the arrangement of the following words in a logical and meaningful order. 1. Universe 2. Chennai 3. World 4. Asia 5. Tamil Nadu

(A) 1, 4, 3, 5, 2
(B) 1, 3, 4, 2, 5
(C) 1, 3, 4, 5, 2
(D) 3, 1, 5, 4, 2

Q.15

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given letter series will complete the series. a _ bcd _ _ aabc _ dea _ _ cd _ e

(A) adebdda
(B) adedabd
(C) adabded
(D) dabdade

Q.17
In a certain code language, ENDORSE is written as VMWLIHV. How will INSTRUCT be written in that language?

(A) SNRGSAOT
(B) SMSGSZPR
(C) RMSHRZPG
(D) RMHGIFXG

Q.18
Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 8, 24, 48, 80, ?, 168

(A) 122
(B) 116
(C) 120
(D) 118

Q.19
Vishal has a total of ₹4,100 in the denominations of 5, 10, 20 and 50 rupee notes. He has an equal number of 5 and 10 rupee notes. The number of 20 rupee notes is double the number of 5 rupee notes. The number of 50 rupee notes is thrice the number of 10 rupee notes. How many 5 rupee notes are there with Vishal?

(A) 10
(B) 40
(C) 30
(D) 20

Q.20
Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All computers are calculators. All calculators are boxes. Conclusions: I. All computers are boxes. II. Some boxes are computers.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(B) Only conclusion II follows.
(C) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(D) Only conclusion I follows.

Q.21
In a code language, if FORTUNE is written as 716192122156, then how will OCTOBER be written in the same language?

(A) 16420173819
(B) 16421163619
(C) 14422163519
(D) 1532063618

Q.23
Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. 29 : 36 : 39

(A) 48 : 52 : 55
(B) 54 : 58 : 61
(C) 69 : 72 : 76
(D) 78 : 79 : 82

Q.24
Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term. DEBONAIR : EDRIOBAN : : HALLMARK : ?

(A) LLAMKRAM
(B) AHKRLLMA
(C) AHKRLLAM
(D) AHLLAMKR

Q.25
Select the option that is related to the third number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number. 6 : 27 : : 9 : ?

(A) 66
(B) 74
(C) 110
(D) 95

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1
Which part of India did the Nizams of Asafjahi dynasty rule?

(A) Western kingdoms
(B) Eastern states
(C) Deccan provinces
(D) Northern India

Q.2
Who among the following is the youngest mayor in India as of January 2021?

(A) Sabitha Beegam
(B) Arya Rajendran
(C) Rekha Priyadarshini
(D) Mekala Kavya

Q.3
Which of the following places in India has 0% forest area as per the Indian State of Forest Report 2019?

(A) Andaman and Nicobar Islands
(B) Puducherry
(C) Lakshadweep
(D) Goa

Q.4
Who among the following was a Portuguese writer who wrote about the trade and society in south India?

(A) Niccolao Manucci
(B) Francois Bernier
(C) Jean-Baptiste Tavernier
(D) Duarte Barbosa

Q.5
'Maand' is primarily a traditional folk singing style from _____.

(A) Madhya Pradesh
(B) Jharkhand
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Bihar

Q.6
Which of the following types of computer is used in climate research and weather forecasting?

(A) Mainframe computers
(B) Micro-computers
(C) Supercomputers
(D) Mini-computers

Q.7
Who among the following introduced the concept of electric field for the first time?

(A) Blaise Pascal
(B) Michael Faraday
(C) Charles Augustin de Coulomb
(D) Joseph Henry

Q.8
Which of the following keys will you press in Windows 10 to turn the volume up?

(A) F4
(B) F5
(C) F6
(D) F8

Q.9
Who among the following Indian cricketers holds the record of most number of catches taken by a non-wicketkeeper while standing in the slip cordon, as of January 2021?

(A) VVS Laxman
(B) Manoj Prabhakar
(C) Rahul Dravid
(D) Javagal Srinath

Q.10
Which of the following is the state flower of Manipur?

(A) Foxtail Orchids
(B) Shirui Lily
(C) Pink Rhododendron
(D) Retusa

Q.11
Which of the following months was celebrated as 'Nutrition Month' in India in the year 2020?

(A) December
(B) November
(C) September
(D) August

Q.12
Who among the following was awarded the International Children's Peace Prize 2020?

(A) Malala Yousafzai
(B) Sadat Rahman
(C) Greta Thunberg
(D) Neha Gupta

Q.13
'Nikshay Poshan Yojana' is a scheme introduced by the Government of India to provide nutritional support to _____ patients.

(A) diabetes
(B) arthritis
(C) tuberculosis
(D) cancer

Q.14
Chemicals called _____ link to form proteins.

(A) oxalic acids
(B) amino acids
(C) citric acids
(D) nitric acids

Q.15
In which of the following cities was the 89th Annual General Meeting of the Board of Control for Cricket in India held?

(A) Ahmedabad
(B) Indore
(C) Lucknow
(D) Nagpur

Q.16
Which of the following has a tetragonal crystal system?

(A) Potassium nitrate
(B) Zinc oxide
(C) Cadmium sulphide
(D) Calcium sulphate

Q.17
Which of the following states emerged as a separate state in 1963?

(A) Nagaland
(B) Mizoram
(C) Arunachal Pradesh
(D) Tripura

Q.18
When was the Editors Guild of India founded?

(A) 1982
(B) 1978
(C) 1956
(D) 1989

Q.19
Which present day Indian state came into existence as the Mysore state in 1953?

(A) Kerala
(B) Karnataka
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Andhra Pradesh

Q.20
Where was the world's largest solar tree installed in India in 2020?

(A) Jaipur
(B) Durgapur
(C) Bokaro
(D) Bhopal

Q.21

Which of the following Articles of the Constitution of India mentions 'Continuance of the rights of citizenship'?

(A) Article 12
(B) Article 10
(C) Article 9
(D) Article 11

Q.22

Who among the following athletes was the first ever youth ambassador of United Nations International Children's Emergency Fund (UNICEF) India?

(A) Dutee Chand
(B) KT Irfan
(C) Neeraj Chopra
(D) Hima Das

Q.23

Where was the first factory of the Indian Iron and Steel Company (IISCO) set up?

(A) Durgapur
(B) Jabalpur
(C) Jamshedpur
(D) Hirapur

Q.24

Which of the following states has the longest roadway network as on March 2021?

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Maharashtra
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Gujarat

Q.25

'Rahide' is a long scarf worn by the women of _____ to protect their head from cool breeze as well as to show their traditional social affinity.

(A) Madhya Pradesh
(B) Himachal Pradesh
(C) Uttar Pradesh
(D) Arunachal Pradesh

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Intelligence

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(A)**	

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (D) Aviary

An aviary is a large enclosure for keeping birds; an apiary is where bees are kept, and an aquarium holds fish.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Insert

To 'expunge' is to erase or remove something completely; its opposite is 'insert'.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Oppose

To 'uphold' is to support or maintain; its opposite is 'oppose'.

Q.4 · Answer (D) DACB

D introduces Ranji in Rajpur, A says his school was closed, C has him wandering alone in the hills and B ('one such day') follows: DACB.

Q.5 · Answer (B) The Prime Minister chair a high-level meeting

The singular subject 'The Prime Minister' needs a singular verb: 'chairs' (or 'chaired') a high-level meeting.

Q.6 · Answer (B) fluctuated

A price that rises and falls again and again 'fluctuates'.

Q.7 · Answer (A) bridle

A bridle is the set of straps on a horse's head used to control it; 'bridal' (of a bride) only sounds the same, and a saddle and stirrups are for the rider.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Mother said that all the guests would arrive that night.

After 'said', 'will' moves back to 'would' and 'tonight' becomes 'that night'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) BACD

B introduces Jamawar, A explains its name ('War' means a yard), C follows with people buying a yard of the shawl and D ends with what the fabric is made of: BACD.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Ordinary workers in a company

The 'rank and file' are the ordinary members of an organisation, as opposed to its leaders.

Q.11 · Answer (A) forever

To do something 'for good' is to do it permanently: forever.

Q.12 · Answer (B) No substitution required

'Unless' means 'if ... not', which is the sense here: the garbage will not be cleared if no one complains. The sentence is correct as it stands.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Rinckle

The correct spelling is 'wrinkle'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) yet living

In a positive statement an action that is continuing takes 'still', not 'yet': 'We are still living in the same house.'

Q.15 · Answer (A) desert

To 'forsake' is to abandon: 'desert'.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Abundant

'Profuse' means plentiful: 'abundant'. 'Meagre' and 'limited' are its opposites.

Q.17 · Answer (A) The sun was hidden by the clouds.

The simple past active 'hid' becomes the simple past passive 'was hidden', with 'the sun' as subject.

Q.18 · Answer (C) misrable

The correct spelling is 'miserable'.

Q.19 · Answer (C) been sitting
The present perfect continuous is 'have been' + -ing, and resting on a seat is 'sitting': 'How long have you been sitting on this bench?' (To 'seat' someone is to give them a seat.)

Q.20 · Answer (D) fare
The price paid for a journey is the 'fare': the air fare.

Q.21 · Answer (C) lies
'Their uniqueness lies in their manufacturing': the singular subject and a general fact take the simple present 'lies'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) purely
'Purely' means entirely, with nothing else: the carpets are made wholly by hand.

Q.23 · Answer (C) choose
You can 'choose' different carpets from a variety of silk or woollen ones.

Q.24 · Answer (B) designed
The carpets are 'designed' in colourful themes: made to a planned pattern.

Q.25 · Answer (D) associated
The main art of carpet making 'is associated with', that is connected with, the knotting, as the next sentence explains.

General Intelligence

Q.2 · Answer (C) Chandigarh
Delhi, Puducherry and Jammu & Kashmir are union territories with legislative assemblies of their own. Chandigarh has none, so it is the odd one.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 13 : 169
In 17 : 291, 15 : 227 and 11 : 123 the second number is the square of the first plus 2 ($17^2 + 2 = 291$). 13 : 169 is 13^2 with nothing added, so it is the odd one.

Q.6 · Answer (A) (9, 5, 56)
The third number is the difference of the squares of the first two: $7^2 - 4^2 = 49 - 16 = 33$. Likewise $9^2 - 5^2 = 81 - 25 = 56$.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 5 and 2
Interchanging 5 and 2: $72 \div 18 + 21 \times 8 - 85 = 4 + 168 - 85 = 87$.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Grandson
The son of Kshitij's son is Kshitij's grandson, and his brother Raman is a grandson too.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Urge : Request
Growth and expansion mean much the same, as do urge and request (both ask for something). First and last, and temporary and permanent, are opposites.

Q.13 · Answer (A) KMQT
In LNQU, QSVZ and ACFJ the letters move +2, +3, +4. KMQT moves +2, +4, +3, so it is the odd one.

Q.14 · Answer (C) 1, 3, 4, 5, 2
From the largest to the smallest: Universe (1), World (3), Asia (4), Tamil Nadu (5), Chennai (2).

Q.15 · Answer (B) adedabd
With a, d, e, d, a, b, d in the blanks the block aabcdde repeats: aabcdde aabcdde aabcdde.

Q.17 · Answer (D) RMHGIFXG
Each letter is replaced by its opposite in the alphabet (A ↔ Z, B ↔ Y and so on): E → V, N → M, D → W, O → L, R → I, S → H. So INSTRUCT → R M H G I F X G: RMHGIFXG.

Q.18 · Answer (C) 120

The differences rise by 8: 16, 24, 32, 40, 48. So 80 + 40 = 120, and 120 + 48 = 168.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 20

With x notes each of ₹5 and ₹10, 2x of ₹20 and 3x of ₹50: 5x + 10x + 40x + 150x = 205x = 4,100, so x = 20.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Both conclusions I and II follow.

All computers are calculators and all calculators are boxes, so all computers are boxes (I); and so some boxes are computers (II). Both follow.

Q.21 · Answer (B) 16421163619

Each letter is written as its place in the alphabet plus 1: F (6) → 7, O (15) → 16, R (18) → 19 and so on. OCTOBER → 16, 4, 21, 16, 3, 6, 19: 16421163619.

Q.23 · Answer (A) 48 : 52 : 55

Each number is the one before it plus the difference of its digits: 29 + (9 – 2) = 36 and 36 + (6 – 3) = 39. Likewise 48 + (8 – 4) = 52 and 52 + (5 – 2) = 55. 54 : 58 : 61 has the same gaps but fails the rule: 54 + (5 – 4) = 55.

Q.24 · Answer (C) AHKRLLAM

The letters are taken in pairs, each pair reversed and the pairs put in the order 1, 4, 2, 3: DE BO NA IR → ED RI OB AN. So HA LL MA RK → AH KR LL AM: AHKRLLAM.

Q.25 · Answer (A) 66

$(6 – 1)^2 + 2 = 27$. Likewise $(9 – 1)^2 + 2 = 66$.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Deccan provinces

The Asaf Jahi Nizams ruled Hyderabad State in the Deccan from 1724, when Nizam-ul-Mulk Asaf Jah I made himself independent of the Mughals, until 1948.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Arya Rajendran

Arya Rajendran became Mayor of Thiruvananthapuram in December 2020 at the age of 21, the youngest mayor in India.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Lakshadweep

The India State of Forest Report 2019 shows no recorded forest area in Lakshadweep (no land there is notified or recorded as forest), although its tree-covered land, mostly coconut plantations, still counts as forest cover, about 90% of its area.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Duarte Barbosa

Duarte Barbosa, a Portuguese official in India early in the sixteenth century, wrote a detailed account of trade and society in south India. Manucci was Venetian, and Bernier and Tavernier were French.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Rajasthan

Maand is a Rajasthani folk singing style, once sung in the royal courts; 'Kesariya Balam' is its best-known song.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Supercomputers

Weather forecasting and climate modelling need enormous numbers of calculations, so they are run on supercomputers.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Michael Faraday

Michael Faraday introduced the idea of a field, picturing electric and magnetic forces as lines of force filling the space around charges and magnets.

Q.8 · Answer (D) F8
SSC's key gives F8. Windows itself assigns no function key to the volume; the media keys are set by the keyboard's maker. On HP and Samsung laptops, for example, F6, F7 and F8 are mute, volume down and volume up, while Dell and Lenovo use F1, F2 and F3.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Rahul Dravid
Rahul Dravid, a specialist slip fielder, took 210 catches in Test cricket, the world record for a non-wicketkeeper when the question was set.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Shirui Lily
The Shirui lily, which grows wild only on the Shirui hills of Ukhrul district, is Manipur's state flower.

Q.11 · Answer (C) September
Since 2018 September has been observed as Rashtriya Poshan Maah (National Nutrition Month) under the POSHAN Abhiyaan.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Sadat Rahman
Sadat Rahman of Bangladesh won the International Children's Peace Prize 2020 for his work against cyberbullying, including the 'Cyber Teens' app.

Q.13 · Answer (C) tuberculosis
Under the Nikshay Poshan Yojana, launched in 2018, tuberculosis patients were paid ₹500 a month by direct benefit transfer for nutritional support during treatment; the amount was raised to ₹1,000 in October 2024.

Q.14 · Answer (B) amino acids
Proteins are chains of amino acids joined by peptide bonds.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Ahmedabad
The BCCI's 89th Annual General Meeting was held in Ahmedabad on 24 December 2020; it approved a ten-team IPL from 2022.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Calcium sulphate
SSC's key follows NCERT's table of the seven crystal systems, which lists calcium sulphate among its tetragonal examples, potassium nitrate as orthorhombic and zinc oxide and cadmium sulphide as hexagonal. (Mineralogists class anhydrite, natural calcium sulphate, as orthorhombic.)

Q.17 · Answer (A) Nagaland
Nagaland became a state on 1 December 1963. Tripura became a state in 1972, and Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 1978
The Editors Guild of India was founded in 1978 to protect press freedom and raise the standards of editorial leadership.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Karnataka
SSC's key gives Karnataka, the only one of these states ever called Mysore. Mysore State gained most of Bellary district from Madras on 1 October 1953 under the Andhra State Act, took its present shape on 1 November 1956 and was renamed Karnataka in 1973.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Durgapur
The world's largest solar tree was installed in 2020 by CSIR-CMERI (the Central Mechanical Engineering Research Institute) at Durgapur, West Bengal.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Article 10
Article 10 provides that every person who is or is deemed to be a citizen under the preceding provisions continues to be one, subject to any law made by Parliament. Article 9 deals with acquiring a foreign citizenship, Article 11 lets Parliament regulate citizenship by law and Article 12 defines 'the State'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Hima Das
In November 2018 UNICEF India named the sprinter Hima Das its first youth ambassador.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Hirapur
IISCO, formed in 1918, set up its first factory at Hirapur and later another at Kulti, both near Asansol in West Bengal.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Maharashtra
Maharashtra has the longest road network of any Indian state, national highways included.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Himachal Pradesh
SSC's key gives Himachal Pradesh, where women wear the rahide, a long scarf over the head.

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